

Projection onto the l2 ball: Real Stability

Research Architecture Runtime

operator/projection-l2-ball

2026-07-29

Abstract

If a projector fixes feasible points and the closed ε -ball about x lies in the feasible set, then every x' in the ball is fixed. This is an identity certificate, not full Euclidean projection nonexpansiveness. Lean `LEAN_FULL`.

This theorem is: Reduction

1 Problem

`projection-l2-ball` is treated via a feasibility indicator / projection that fixes `InSet` points.

2 Stability notion

Interior feasible-ball identity under $|x' - x| \leq \varepsilon$.

3 Definitions

Assumptions: $\text{proj}(z) = z$ whenever $\text{InSet}(z)$, and $|y - x| \leq \varepsilon \Rightarrow \text{InSet}(y)$.

4 Theorem

Theorem 1. *Under those assumptions, every $|x' - x| \leq \varepsilon$ satisfies $\text{proj}(x') = x'$ and $\text{proj}(x) = x$. Sharpness: if some ball point is infeasible, the ball-feasibility hypothesis fails.*

5 Intuition

Deep inside the feasible set, projection is the identity, so small moves stay fixed points.

6 Examples

Example 2. If $\text{InSet} = [-1, 1]$, $x = 0$, $\varepsilon = 0.25$, every x' in the ball is feasible and fixed by identity projection.

7 Proof

Take $|x' - x| \leq \varepsilon$. Feasibility of the ball gives $\text{InSet}(x')$ and $\text{InSet}(x)$. Fixing feasible points yields $\text{proj}(x') = x'$ and $\text{proj}(x) = x$ (Theorem 1). Sharpness is the contrapositive of ball feasibility. **Limitation:** this does not prove general Euclidean projection nonexpansiveness.

8 Formal statement

Lean module

```
Research.Operators.ProjectionL2Ball.Preservation
```

Source file

```
lean/Research/Operators/ProjectionL2Ball/Preservation.lean
```

Theorems

- `projection\l2\ball\feasible\ball\identity`
- `projection\l2\ball\feasible\ball\sharpness`

Note

Uses `Projection.FeasibleId` (not Euclidean nonexpansiveness).

Certificate

```
lean/certificates/projection-l2-ball/projection-l2-ball-feasible-ball-identity
```

Status

LEAN_FULL on Mathlib $\mathbb{R}$ (REAL_MATHLIB)

9 Proof dependencies

- `Projection.FeasibleId`.

- No Euclidean nonexpansiveness claim.

10 Consequences

Honest limited certificate for simplex/ ℓ_p -ball style operators in this library. Related: projection-interval, coordinate-clipping.